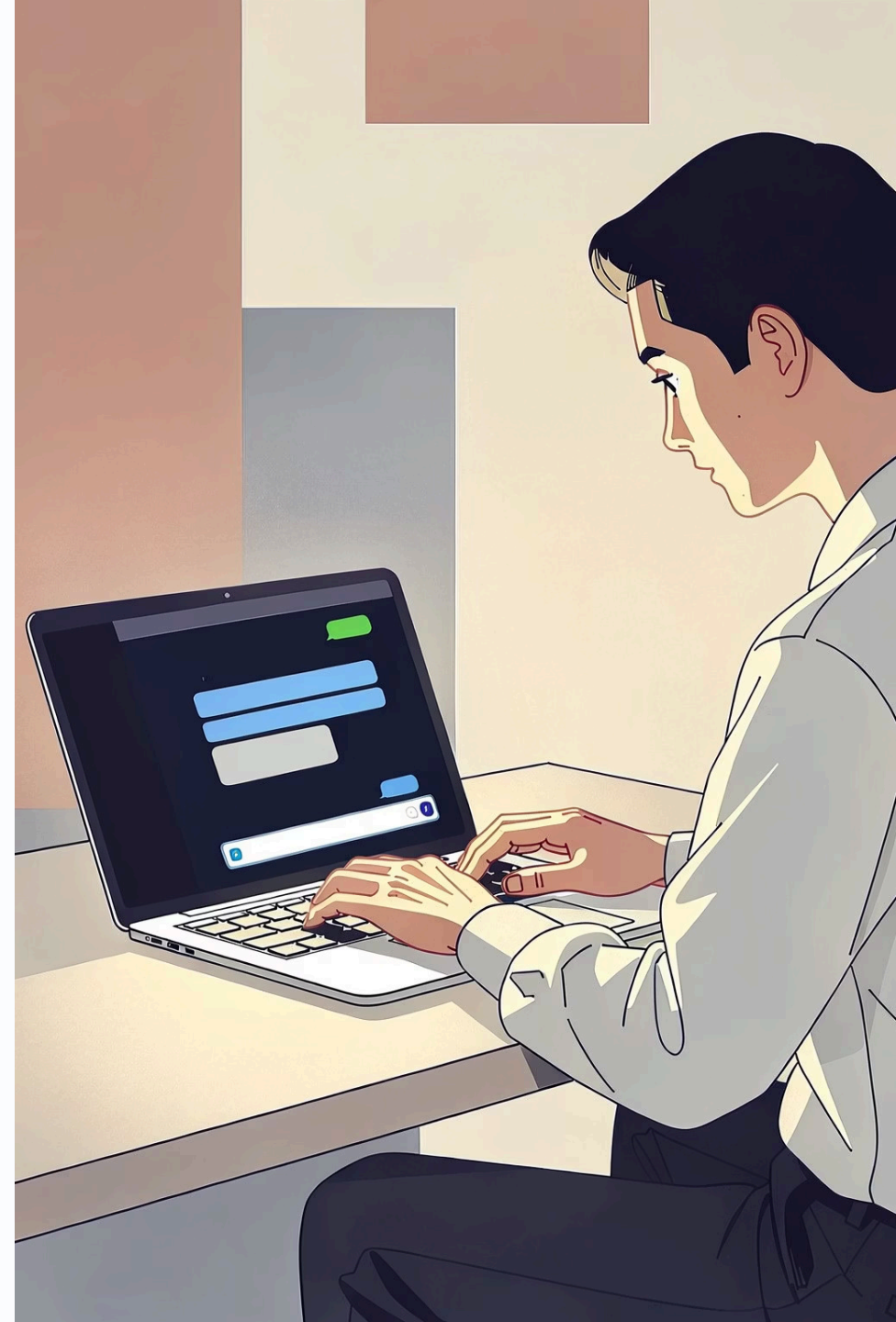


Session 11: The Art of Prompting

You've used ChatGPT and Gemini a lot now. You've noticed some prompts work great and some are kind of generic.

Today, you start learning the craft of prompt engineering - how to write instructions that get consistently better results from AI.



Objectives

By the end of this session, you'll be able to:

01

Define a Prompt

Say what a **prompt** is and why it matters

02

Name the 5 Parts

Identify the **5 parts of a great prompt**

03

Spot Mistakes

Recognize mistakes that make prompts fail

04

Upgrade Prompts

Turn weak prompts into **strong prompts**

05

Build Your Library

Start your very own **Prompt Library!**



Recap & Homework

Welcome back! Show me your AI Decisions Diary.

Your Diary Check-In

- When did you USE AI? Was it the right call?
- When did you NOT use AI? Could you have?
- Any surprises?

Quick Check from Last Week

- What's Human-in-the-Loop?
- When should you NOT use AI?
- What's an AI strength vs. weakness?

Warm-Up : Have You Felt This?

Imagine you text your friend...

 You

"Help."

 Friend

"??? With what??"

 You

"You know - the thing."

 Friend

"Bro I have NO idea what you're talking about 🙄"

 **Vague messages = confused replies.** Same with AI! If your prompt is unclear, AI's answer will be unclear too.

What is a Prompt?

Prompt is your instruction to AI. It's literally what you type to tell AI what you want.

Example 1

"Write me a birthday poem."

Example 2

"Explain photosynthesis."

Example 3

"Give me 10 ideas for a science project."

✓ **The better the prompt → the better the answer.** That's why prompting is a SKILL worth learning.





The Coach Idea

Think of AI like a brilliant teammate.

It can do almost anything - but it needs clear directions. You're not just typing. You're **coaching**.

- **Clear Instructions**
Tell AI exactly what to do
- **Context**
What's going on? What's the situation?
- **Goal**
What does success look like?

📌 A good prompt does the same thing a good coach does.

The 5 Parts of a Great Prompt

A great prompt has **5 ingredients**. You don't need them in this order - it's a checklist to make sure you've included all 5 parts in whatever order sounds natural.

Action

What should AI DO? (write, make, list, explain)

Topic

What's it ABOUT? (dogs, soccer, your school project)

Context

Who is this for? Why? (for a 5-year-old? a friend?)

Format

How should it look? (a list? a poem? 3 sentences?)

Constraints

Any limits? (short, funny, no big words)

Building a Great Prompt - Step by Step

Watch how each part makes the prompt **stronger**:

Just an Action

"Write." - Too vague!

Add Topic

"Write a poem about dogs." - Better!

Add Context

"Write a poem about dogs for my 7-year-old sister." - Even better!

Add Format

"Write a 4-line poem about dogs for my 7-year-old sister." - Great!

Add Constraints

"Write a 4-line, funny, rhyming poem about dogs for my 7-year-old sister." - Perfect!



Mini Activity 1 - Spot the Parts!

"Make me a list of 5 fun games for a kid's birthday party at home.

Keep it simple - under 10 minutes per game. No expensive supplies needed."

🔍 Can you find all 5 parts? Let's break it down:

Part	Found in the Prompt
🎯 Action	Make a list
📖 Topic	Fun games for a kid's birthday party
🏠 Context	At home
📋 Format	A list of 5
⌚ Constraints	Under 10 min per game, no expensive supplies

✅ **See how much info AI got?** That's why this prompt would work great.

5 Mistakes That Wreck Prompts

These mistakes make AI's answers bad. **Avoid them!**

Too Vague

"Tell me stuff about animals." - What animals? What stuff?

No Context

"Write a poem." - For who? About what?

Not Iterating

"First answer is fine, I guess." - Always try to improve it!

Too Much at Once

"Write a poem AND a story AND a song AND a quiz..." - Pick one!

Not Checking

"AI said it, must be true." - Always verify!

 More clarity = better answers.

Mini Activity 2 - Fix the Bad Prompt!

Each prompt below is **BAD**. Can you fix it? For each one, add the missing parts (action, topic, context, format, constraints):

Bad Prompt	Your Better Prompt
"Tell me about space."	_____
"Write a story."	_____
"Help me with school."	_____
"Make a picture."	_____

 Think about what's missing - action, topic, context, format, or constraints. Add them all!

Mini Activity 2 - Example Fixes

There's no single right answer! Here's ONE way to fix each one - yours might be different and still great.

Bad Prompt	Better Prompt
"Tell me about space."	"Tell me 3 cool facts about Saturn for a 10-year-old. Make it short."
"Write a story."	"Write a 5-sentence funny story about a robot who learned to dance."
"Help me with school."	"Explain fractions to me like I'm in 5th grade, with one easy example."
"Make a picture."	"Make a cartoon image of a dragon wearing a chef hat, baking cookies. Bright colors."

👍 **Notice:** Every fix adds **specifics**. That's the magic.



Iterate - Keep Making It Better!

Real prompting is **not** "type it once and done." It's a **loop** - and that loop is where the magic happens.



Write a Prompt

Start with your best attempt - be clear and specific about what you need.



Get the Answer

Let the AI respond and generate its output based on your prompt.



Is It Good Enough?

Evaluate the result critically. Does it meet your goal? What's missing?



Improve & Try Again

Refine your prompt based on what you learned and run it again.



Pro tip: Even great prompt engineers iterate **3–5 times** before they're happy. Iteration isn't a sign of failure - it's the process.

Example of Iteration

Goal: A poem about your cat.



"Write a poem about my cat."

Generic poem about cats.



"Write a poem about my fluffy orange cat named Whiskers."

Better - now it's actually about **Whiskers!**



"Write a funny, 4-line, rhyming poem about my fluffy orange cat Whiskers who loves to knock things off tables."

Perfect. Exactly what you wanted.

⚠ Heads up: Sometimes your next try is **WORSE** than the first. That's also normal! Iteration means trying - not always succeeding right away. Keep going.





The Magic Formula



ACTION

What do you want done?



TOPIC

What is it about?



CONTEXT

What's the situation?



FORMAT

How should it look?



CONSTRAINTS

What are the limits?

You don't ALWAYS need all 5. But the more you include, the better the result.

Example : *"[Make a list] of [10 fun outdoor games] [for a 10-year-old's birthday party] [as a numbered list] [each one under 5 minutes to set up]."*

Hands-On Activity - Prompt Playground! 🎮

Time to play with prompts and see what works.

- **Pick a Real Task**

Choose something you actually want AI's help with TODAY

- **Write Your Best Prompt**

Use all 5 parts: Action, Topic, Context, Format, Constraints

- **Try It Out**

Test it in ChatGPT or Gemini and see what you get

- **Evaluate the Answer**

Is it what you wanted? What's missing?

- **Make It Better**

Improve the prompt and try again!

☑ You'll save your best prompts to your **Prompt Library**.

Ideas to Try

Pick **ONE** that you actually need right now:

- **Plan a Fun Activity**
Weekend plans, outings, or events - let's make it happen.
- **Explain a School Topic**
Pick a real topic you're struggling with and get it explained clearly.
- **Brainstorm Ideas**
Got a problem? Generate creative solutions and fresh perspectives.
- **Pick a Gift**
Help choosing the perfect gift for someone special.
- **Write a Draft**
A card, a story, a paragraph - get a solid first draft going.
- **Make a Study Plan**
Prep for a test with a structured, realistic study schedule.

☐ Whatever you pick - apply the 5 parts.



Walk Through Your Prompt

Answer each question, then combine into ONE prompt.

1

What's your action?

write, make, explain, list...

2

What's your topic?

What's it about?

3

What's the context?

Who is it for? What's the situation?

4

What format?

List? Paragraph? Poem? Bullet points?

5

Any constraints?

Short, funny, simple, etc.

 **The trickiest part is usually CONTEXT.** Don't skip it - "for a 5-year-old" or "for my mom's birthday" changes EVERYTHING about what AI gives you.

Try → Improve → Try Again

After you see the first answer, ask yourself:

Was it what I wanted?

Was anything missing?

Was it too long? Too short? Wrong tone?

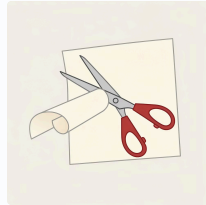
Now change ONE thing in your prompt and try again.

Examples of improvements:



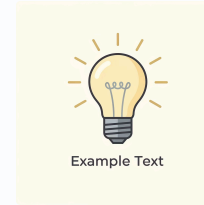
"Make it funnier"

Shift the tone when the response feels too stiff or formal.



"Make it shorter - only 3 sentences"

Add a length constraint when the output is bloated.



"Add an example"

Ask for a concrete illustration when things feel abstract.



"Make it sound more excited"

Request a specific energy level when the voice feels flat.

✔ **Iterate until you're happy.**



Save It!

Start Your Prompt Library

Every time you find a prompt that worked GREAT - **save it!**

Reuse Later

Great prompts can be used again and again for similar tasks

Learn What Works

Your saved prompts teach you patterns that get great results

Personal Toolkit

They become YOUR personal AI toolkit - unique to you

- ❏ **What counts as save - worthy?** Any prompt that gave you results you'd want again. If it worked, save it. Today, save at least ONE prompt to your library.

Prompt Library Template

Use this simple format for each prompt you save. Don't overthink it - just save the prompt + a quick note.



Date

When did you use this prompt?



What I Wanted

What were you trying to accomplish?



Tool Used

ChatGPT, Gemini, or another AI tool?



My Final Prompt

The exact prompt that worked great



What Worked

What did you love about the result?



What I'd Change

What would you tweak next time?

What We Learned this Session:

You covered a lot of ground. Here's your summary:

✓ Prompt

The instruction you give to AI - the starting point of everything

✓ 5 Parts

Action + Topic + Context + Format + Constraints

✓ 5 Mistakes

Vague, no context, not iterating, too much at once, not checking

✓ Iterate

Write, test, improve, repeat - that's the real process

✓ Prompt Library

Your growing personal toolkit of prompts that work

Your Homework - Add to Your Prompt Library

Add at least TWO entries to your Prompt Library.

01

Think of Two Tasks

Find TWO things you actually want help with this week

02

Write Great Prompts

Write a great prompt for each using all 5 parts!

03

Test Them

Try each prompt in ChatGPT or Gemini

04

Iterate at Least Once

Even if the first answer is good, try to make it BETTER

05

Save to Your Library

Save the final version using the Prompt Library template



Plan your weekend



Come up with a story idea



Study for a test



Pick a gift for someone

Challenge

Want a stretch? Take ONE prompt from today and try it in BOTH **ChatGPT** AND **Gemini**.

“

🤔 Did they answer differently?

Compare the two responses side by side

”

“

🤔 Which one did better?

Which tool gave you the more useful answer?

”

“

🤔 Did you need to change the prompt?

Did one tool need a different style of prompt to get good results?

”

✅ **Different tools sometimes need different prompts. Knowing that = pro level.**

Next Time - Session 12:

Advanced Prompting Techniques

You've learned the basics. Next session, we go **PRO**. We'll learn cool techniques that real prompt engineers use every day.



Role Prompting

"Pretend you're a pirate" - give AI a persona to unlock new styles



Few-Shot Prompting

Teach AI by giving examples - show it what you want



Chain-of-Thought

Ask AI to "think step by step" for better reasoning

 **Bring your Prompt Library!** You'll need it for next session.

